CARF Accreditation Report

for

1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion

Three-Year Accreditation

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About CARF

CARF is an independent, non-profit accreditor of health and human services, enhancing the lives of persons served worldwide.

The accreditation process applies CARF's internationally recognized standards during a site survey conducted by peer surveyors. Accreditation, however, is an ongoing process that distinguishes a provider's service delivery and signals to the public that the provider is committed to continuous performance improvement, responsive to feedback, and accountable to the community and its other stakeholders.

CARF accreditation promotes providers' demonstration of value and Quality Across the Lifespan® of millions of persons served through application of rigorous organizational and program standards organized around the ASPIRE to Excellence® continuous quality improvement framework. CARF accreditation has been the recognized benchmark of quality health and human services for more than 50 years.

For more information or to contact CARF, please visit www.carf.org/contact-us.

Organization

1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion
527 Ellis Street
Penticton BC V2A 4M4
CANADA

Organizational Leadership

Leanne Williams, CEO

Survey Number

187038

Survey Date(s)

November 20, 2024–November 22, 2024

Surveyor(s)

Pam Satterfield, Administrative
Linda Siino, MSW, Program

Program(s)/Service(s) Surveyed

Community Employment Services: Employment Supports
Community Employment Services: Job Development
Community Integration
Host Family/Shared Living Services
Supported Living

Previous Survey

November 4, 2021–November 5, 2021
Three-Year Accreditation

Accreditation Decision

Three-Year Accreditation
Expiration: November 30, 2027

Executive Summary

This report contains the findings of CARF's site survey of 1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion conducted November 20, 2024–November 22, 2024. This report includes the following information:

- Documentation of the accreditation decision and the basis for the decision as determined by CARF's consideration of the survey findings.
- Identification of the specific program(s)/service(s) and location(s) to which this accreditation decision applies.
- Identification of the CARF surveyor(s) who conducted the survey and an overview of the CARF survey process and how conformance to the standards was determined.
- Feedback on the organization's strengths and recognition of any areas where the organization demonstrated exemplary conformance to the standards.
- Documentation of the specific sections of the CARF standards that were applied on the survey.
- Recommendations for improvement in any areas where the organization did not meet the minimum requirements to demonstrate full conformance to the standards.
- Any consultative suggestions documented by the surveyor(s) to help the organization improve its program(s)/service(s) and business operations.

Accreditation Decision

On balance, 1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion demonstrated substantial conformance to the standards. Okanagan Inclusion provides quality community-integrated services that benefit the individuals served, are valued by other stakeholders, and are respected within the community. The leadership and staff members showed a strong dedication to meeting the service-related challenges of the individuals served with diligence, creativity, flexibility, and a team-based approach. The strong sense of the organization's mission and leadership's guidance to the personnel are reflected in and supported by the dedication of Okanagan Inclusion's employees and the overall satisfaction they express in their jobs. The organization adapts to the needs of each individual served in a positive community inclusion experience. Okanagan Inclusion is attuned to the needs and preferences of the individual served, their families, and other stakeholders. The organization provides quality services with a small leadership team that oversees a well-trained staff. There is an opportunity for improvement noted in the area of community employment services related to developing individual service plans for job development.

1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion appears likely to maintain and/or improve its current method of operation and demonstrates a commitment to ongoing quality improvement. 1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion is required to submit a post-survey Quality Improvement Plan (QIP) to CARF that addresses all recommendations identified in this report.

1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion has earned a Three-Year Accreditation. The leadership team and staff are complimented and congratulated for this achievement. In order to maintain this accreditation, throughout the term of accreditation, the organization is required to:

- Submit annual reporting documents and other required information to CARF, as detailed in the Accreditation Policies and Procedures section in the standards manual.
- Maintain ongoing conformance to CARF's standards, satisfy all accreditation conditions, and comply with all accreditation policies and procedures, as they are published and made effective by CARF.

Survey Details

Survey Participants

The survey of 1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion was conducted by the following CARF surveyor(s):

- Pam Satterfield, Administrative
- Linda Siino, MSW, Program

CARF considers the involvement of persons served to be vital to the survey process. As part of the accreditation survey for all organizations, CARF surveyors interact with and conduct direct, confidential interviews with consenting current and former persons served in the program(s)/service(s) for which the organization is seeking accreditation. In addition, as applicable and available, interviews may be conducted with family members and/or representatives of the persons served such as guardians, advocates, or members of their support system.

Interviews are also conducted with individuals associated with the organization, as applicable, which may include:

- The organization's leadership, such as board members, executives, owners, and managers.
- Business unit resources, such as finance and human resources.
- Personnel who serve and directly interact with persons served in the program(s)/service(s) for which the organization is seeking accreditation.
- Other stakeholders, such as referral sources, payers, insurers, and fiscal intermediaries.
- Community constituents and governmental representatives.

Survey Activities

Achieving CARF accreditation involves demonstrating conformance to the applicable CARF standards, evidenced through observable practices, verifiable results over time, and comprehensive supporting documentation. The survey of 1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion and its program(s)/service(s) consisted of the following activities:

- Confidential interviews and direct interactions, as outlined in the previous section.
- Direct observation of the organization's operations and service delivery practices.
- Observation of the organization's location(s) where services are delivered.
- Review of organizational documents, which may include policies; plans; written procedures; promotional materials; governing documents, such as articles of incorporation and bylaws; financial statements; and other documents necessary to determine conformance to standards.
- Review of documents related to program/service design, delivery, outcomes, and improvement, such as program descriptions, records of services provided, documentation of reviews of program resources and services conducted, and program evaluations.
- Review of records of current and former persons served.

Program(s)/Service(s) Surveyed

The survey addressed by this report is specific to the following program(s)/service(s):

- Community Employment Services: Employment Supports
- Community Employment Services: Job Development
- Community Integration
- Host Family/Shared Living Services
- Supported Living

A list of the organization's accredited program(s)/service(s) by location is included at the end of this report.

Representations and Constraints

The accreditation decision and survey findings contained in this report are based on an on-balance consideration of the information obtained by the surveyor(s) during the site survey. Any information that was unavailable, not presented, or outside the scope of the survey was not considered and, had it been considered, may have affected the contents of this report. If at any time CARF subsequently learns or has reason to believe that the organization did not participate in the accreditation process in good faith or that any information presented was not accurate, truthful, or complete, CARF may modify the accreditation decision, up to and including revocation of accreditation.

Survey Findings

This report provides a summary of the organization's strengths and identifies the sections of the CARF standards that were applied on the survey and the findings in each area. In conjunction with its evaluation of conformance to the specific program/service standards, CARF assessed conformance to its business practice standards, referred to as Section 1. ASPIRE to Excellence, which are designed to support the delivery of the program(s)/service(s) within a sound business operating framework to promote long-term success.

The specific standards applied from each section vary based on a variety of factors, including, but not limited to, the scope(s) of the program(s)/service(s), population(s) served, location(s), methods of service delivery, and survey type. Information about the specific standards applied on each survey is included in the standards manual and other instructions that may be provided by CARF.

Areas of Strength

CARF found that 1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion demonstrated the following strengths:

- Okanagan Inclusion provides a warm and welcoming environment for all who enter its programs. Staff members support the individuals served and each other in achieving the organization's overall mission and vision. Staff members respond to the individuals, families, and visitors in a warm and engaging manner. The inclusion programs are presented in a relaxing environment that displays the individuals' photos and arts and crafts for a more personal touch.

- The organization is praised for its different communication levels within the organization. It has a client-led meeting that addresses reducing physical risk, infectious diseases, rights, and information/feedback. This information is then shared and expanded on with staff members to address the individuals' concerns, interests, and needs. Stakeholder communication is done via face-to-face, phone conversations, and meetings throughout the year. All meetings are then shared with upper management to develop new activities, address concerns, or incorporate them into any CARF accreditation plan. This communication process ensures that everyone has a voice within the organization.
- The organization has a pronounced presence within the communities at both inclusion locations, as evidenced by the different activities it is involved in (e.g., the OSNS golf tournament, a community council barbeque, the ALERT cookie fundraiser, a community inclusion dance, and an art show). They have partnered with one of the islands on a pen pal project. Okanagan Inclusion is considered by the community to be one of the outstanding programs for funding and referral sources to assist individuals.
- The organization's funding source described it as "very community-driven," with "clear communication between the individuals and families." The source also praised Okanagan Inclusion for "responding timely to referral requests" and being "knowledgeable about policy and procedures for service delivery." The funding source highly regards the CEO and team members for their mission-driven approach.
- The organization has shown financial growth over the years. It is very mindful of expenses, while ensuring that the needs of the individuals are met. It is resourceful in helping to offset costs in different ways, such as applying for a Workplace Accessibility Grant and securing funding for one new van.
- The Relias® training system has been a great asset to the organization in providing competency-based training. In addition, Okanagan Inclusion has been resourceful in bringing in behavioural health specialists and nursing specialists to provide face-to-face training on different areas identified by the staff or upper management.
- The cohesive nature, team spirit, and overall dedication to seeing the organization's mission accomplished was undeniable at Okanagan Inclusion. Although the leadership team is small in number and performs a myriad of functions, it remains dedicated to the staff and the individuals. The passion that the leadership exhibits and the way that the leadership staff members care for the individuals is remarkable. They never hesitate to step in on a daily basis to care for the needs of the individuals and provide them with meaningful activities, support in finding a job, or any other type of support needed.
- The organization maintains an excellent individual handbook that is detailed, clear, and provides useful information to both current and new individuals alike. The handbook is detailed and easy to read or review with the individuals served. A colourful flyer adapted by the organization to communicate the rights of the individuals is utilized and is quite attractive and engaging.
- The Keremos community inclusion location serves both individuals and groups in a small, welcoming community where community members know, accept, and contribute to the individuals in many ways. Many creative activities are based on a schedule that the individuals contribute to. Cooking, art, games, and much more are offered by passionate staff members. The individuals served have put much time and effort into developing their own unique board game with pieces or tokens created by each individual. In addition, the organization is congratulated for operating a professional hot dog stand, with support from the staff, where proceeds are used to fund summer camp participation for all interested individuals. Community members eagerly look forward to purchasing snacks or lunch from the team.
- Okanagan Inclusion provides community integration services in Penticton, BC. The services are provided on an individualized basis, promoting social, personal, and other community skills based on the needs and desires of the individuals served. Leisure, recreational, pre-vocational (i.e., volunteering), and development of daily living skills are provided using a person-centred approach where the individuals participate in opportunities to achieve value as community members. The staff members are congratulated for assisting the individuals to participate outside the site as much as possible.

- Okanagan Inclusion provides excellent community employment services. The employment developer/job coach serves in multiple roles developing relationships with prospective employers and canvassing the community for employment opportunities for the job seekers. One individual who, through Okanagan Inclusion, was able to obtain local employment, reported that she was pleased with diligent support her job coach provided, crediting the support with ensuring that she satisfactorily completes all tasks. The staff's and the individuals' positive, friendly, yet professional relationship was evident.
- Okanagan Inclusion provides stellar shared living services. A provider provides support to the individual(s) living in the home, including offering respect and care with coordination from the organization. The providers are knowledgeable about each individual's needs and preferences, and work to develop positive relationships with each individual. Okanagan Inclusion's shared living services coordinator also provides quarterly to support to the provider and oversees their interactions with the individuals.

Opportunities for Quality Improvement

The CARF survey process identifies opportunities for continuous improvement, a core concept of "aspiring to excellence." This section of the report lists the sections of the CARF standards that were applied on the survey, including a description of the business practice area and/or the specific program(s)/service(s) surveyed and a summary of the key areas addressed in that section of the standards.

In this section of the report, a recommendation identifies any standard for which CARF determined that the organization did not meet the minimum requirements to demonstrate full conformance. All recommendations must be addressed in a QIP submitted to CARF.

In addition, consultation may be provided for areas of or specific standards where the surveyor(s) documented suggestions that the organization may consider to improve its business or service delivery practices. Note that consultation may be offered for areas of specific standards that do not have any recommendations. Such consultation does not indicate non-conformance to the standards; it is intended to offer ideas that the organization might find helpful in its ongoing quality improvement efforts. The organization is not required to address consultation.

When CARF surveyors visit an organization, their role is that of independent peer reviewers, and their goal is not only to gather and assess information to determine conformance to the standards, but also to engage in relevant and meaningful consultative dialogue. Not all consultation or suggestions discussed during the survey are noted in this report. The organization is encouraged to review any notes made during the survey and consider the consultation or suggestions that were discussed.

During the process of preparing for a CARF accreditation survey, an organization may conduct a detailed self-assessment and engage in deliberations and discussions within the organization as well as with external stakeholders as it considers ways to implement and use the standards to guide its quality improvement efforts. The organization is encouraged to review these discussions and deliberations as it considers ways to implement innovative changes and further advance its business and service delivery practices.

Section 1. ASPIRE to Excellence®

1.A. Leadership

Description

CARF-accredited organizations identify leadership that embraces the values of accountability and responsibility to the individual organization's stated mission. The leadership demonstrates corporate social responsibility.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Leadership structure and responsibilities
■ Person-centred philosophy
■ Organizational guidance
■ Leadership accessibility
■ Cultural competency, diversity, and inclusion
■ Corporate responsibility
■ Organizational fundraising, if applicable

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- Okanagan Inclusion might benefit from contacting physician offices/clinics to place brochures and marketing materials to increase community awareness. The organization might also benefit from putting its website address on the company vehicle to raise public awareness, referrals, and potential applicants.

1.C. Strategic Planning

Description

CARF-accredited organizations establish a foundation for success through strategic planning focused on taking advantage of strengths and opportunities and addressing weaknesses and threats.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Environmental considerations
■ Strategic plan development, implementation, and periodic review

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

1.D. Input from Persons Served and Other Stakeholders

Description

CARF-accredited organizations continually focus on the expectations of the persons served and other stakeholders. The standards in this subsection direct the organization's focus to soliciting, collecting, analyzing, and using input from all stakeholders to create services that meet or exceed the expectations of the persons served, the community, and other stakeholders.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Collection of input from persons served, personnel, and other stakeholders
■ Integration of input into business practices and planning

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

1.E. Legal Requirements

Description

CARF-accredited organizations comply with all legal and regulatory requirements.

Key Areas Addressed

- Compliance with obligations
- Response to legal action
- Confidentiality and security of records

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

1.F. Financial Planning and Management

Description

CARF-accredited organizations strive to be financially responsible and solvent, conducting fiscal management in a manner that supports their mission, values, and performance objectives. Fiscal practices adhere to established accounting principles and business practices. Fiscal management covers daily operational cost management and incorporates plans for long-term solvency.

Key Areas Addressed

- Budgets
- Review of financial results and relevant factors
- Fiscal policies and procedures
- Reviews of bills for services and fee structures, if applicable
- Review/audit of financial statements
- Safeguarding funds of persons served, if applicable

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

1.G. Risk Management

Description

CARF-accredited organizations engage in a coordinated set of activities designed to control threats to their people, property, income, goodwill, and ability to accomplish goals.

Key Areas Addressed

- Risk management plan implementation and periodic review
- Adequate insurance coverage
- Media relations and social media procedures
- Reviews of contract services

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- The organization has suitable communication procedures that address media and social media, but it might expand on what is acceptable and not allowed between the staff and the individuals served using social media.

1.H. Health and Safety

Description

CARF-accredited organizations maintain healthy, safe, and clean environments that support quality services and minimize risk of harm to persons served, personnel, and other stakeholders.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Healthy and safe environment
■ Competency-based training on health and safety procedures and practices
■ Emergency and evacuation procedures
■ Access to first aid and emergency information
■ Critical incidents
■ Infections and communicable diseases
■ Health and safety inspections

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- Okanagan Inclusion might consider adding a star to its evacuation plans to denote the person's location. This could be a visual cue for non-readers or limited readers.
- Okanagan Inclusion has a detailed checklist for first aid and emergency supplies that is checked monthly. It is suggested that instead of check marks, the staff initial the checklist. This could give some accountability to ensure that supplies are present. The organization could also add a column to indicate the expiration date of items within the kit.
- The organization might add to the accident emergency procedures documents within each vehicle transporting the individuals served other types of emergencies that could happen when transporting the individuals, including snow and ice, landslides, medical emergencies, or road closures.

1.I. Workforce Development and Management

Description

CARF-accredited organizations demonstrate that they value their human resources and focus on aligning and linking human resources processes, procedures, and initiatives with the strategic objectives of the organization. Organizational effectiveness depends on the organization's ability to develop and manage the knowledge, skills, abilities, and behavioural expectations of its workforce. The organization describes its workforce, which is often composed of a diverse blend of human resources. Effective workforce development and management promote engagement and organizational sustainability and foster an environment that promotes the provision of services that centre on enhancing the lives of persons served.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Composition of workforce
■ Ongoing workforce planning
■ Verification of backgrounds/credentials/fitness for duty

■ Workforce engagement and development
■ Performance appraisals
■ Succession planning

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- The organization might benefit from developing an employee handbook. This would give the staff a central location to refer to regarding employment policy and procedures after onboarding. Placing employment policy and procedures into one document could require the staff to sign one only paper instead of several. The organization could also use the employee handbook as an annual review tool. This information might benefit the organization and staff if accessible on the website.
- Okanagan Inclusion might increase its application pool by adding job vacancies and applications to its website. The organization could also link its website with other organizations that allow job posting (e.g., colleges, chambers of commerce, or workforce agencies).

1.J. Technology

Description

Guided by leadership and a shared vision, CARF-accredited organizations are committed to exploring and, within their resources, acquiring and implementing technology systems and solutions that will support and enhance:

■ Business processes and practices.
■ Privacy and security of protected information.
■ Service delivery.
■ Performance management and improvement.
■ Satisfaction of persons served, personnel, and other stakeholders.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Ongoing assessment of technology and data use, including input from stakeholders
■ Technology and system plan implementation and periodic review
■ Technology policies and procedures

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- The organization might benefit from implementing a password update every three months to ensure security when accessing information on laptop and desktop computers.

1.K. Rights of Persons Served

Description

CARF-accredited organizations protect and promote the rights of all persons served. This commitment guides the delivery of services and ongoing interactions with the persons served.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Policies that promote rights of persons served
■ Communication of rights to persons served
■ Formal complaints by persons served

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

1.L. Accessibility

Description

CARF-accredited organizations promote accessibility and the removal of barriers for the persons served and other stakeholders.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Assessment of accessibility needs and identification of barriers
■ Accessibility plan implementation and periodic review
■ Requests for reasonable accommodations

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

1.M. Performance Measurement and Management

Description

CARF-accredited organizations demonstrate a culture of accountability by developing and implementing performance measurement and management plans that produce information an organization can act on to improve results for the persons served, other stakeholders, and the organization itself.

The foundation for successful performance measurement and management includes:

■ Leadership accountability and support.
■ Mission-driven measurement.
■ A focus on results achieved for the persons served.
■ Meaningful engagement of stakeholders.
■ An understanding of extenuating and influencing factors that may impact performance.
■ A workforce that is knowledgeable about and engaged in performance measurement and management.
■ An investment in resources to implement performance measurement and management.
■ Measurement and management of business functions to sustain and enhance the organization.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Leadership accountability for performance measurement and management
■ Identification of gaps and opportunities related to performance measurement and management
■ Input from stakeholders
■ Performance measurement and management plan

■ Identification of objectives and performance indicators for service delivery
■ Identification of objectives and performance indicators for priority business functions
■ Personnel training on performance measurement and management

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

1.N. Performance Improvement

Description

CARF-accredited organizations demonstrate a culture of performance improvement through their commitment to proactive and ongoing review, analysis, reflection on their results in both service delivery and business functions, and transparency. The results of performance analysis are used to identify and implement data-driven actions to improve the quality of programs and services and to inform decision making. Performance information that is accurate and understandable to the target audience is shared with persons served, personnel, and other stakeholders in accordance with their interests and needs.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Analysis of service delivery performance
■ Analysis of business function performance
■ Identification of areas needing performance improvement
■ Implementation of action plans
■ Use of performance information to improve program/service quality and make decisions
■ Communication of performance information

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- It is suggested that Okanagan Inclusion consider developing an infographic to recap the performance measurement, management, and improvement plan's yearly progress for the website. This could demonstrate progress to the individuals served, the staff, and other stakeholders in a visual representation of information or data.

Section 2. Quality Individualized Services and Supports

Description

For an organization to achieve quality services, the persons served are active participants in the planning, implementation, and ongoing review and revision of the services offered. The organization's commitment to quality and the involvement of the persons served spans the entire time that the persons served are involved with services. The service planning process is individualized, establishing goals and measurable objectives that incorporate the unique strengths, abilities, needs, and preferences of the persons served. Services are responsive to the expectations of persons served and their desired outcomes from services, and are relevant to their maximum participation in the environments of their choice.

2.A. Program/Service Structure

Description

A fundamental responsibility of the organization is to provide a comprehensive program structure. The staffing is designed to maximize opportunities for the persons served to obtain and participate in the services provided.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Services are person centred and individualized
■ Persons are given information about the organization's purposes and ability to address desired outcomes
■ Documented scope of services shared with stakeholders
■ Service delivery based on accepted field practices
■ Communication for effective service delivery
■ Entrance/exit/transition criteria

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- The organization might consider providing space on the consent form for the individuals served to indicate information they choose not to share and the opportunity to withdraw consent at any time.

2.B. Individual-Centred Service Planning, Design, and Delivery

Description

Improvement of the quality of an individual's services/supports requires a focus on the person and/or family served and their identified strengths, abilities, needs, and preferences. The organization's services are designed around the identified needs and desires of the persons served, are responsive to their expectations and desired outcomes from services, and are relevant to their maximum participation in the environments of their choice.

The person served participates in decision making, directing, and planning that affect the person's life. Efforts to include the person served in the direction or delivery of those services/supports are evident.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Services are person centred and individualized
■ Persons are given information about the organization's purposes and ability to address desired outcomes

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

2.C. Medication Monitoring and Management

Key Areas Addressed

■ Current, complete records of medications used by persons served
■ Written procedures for storage and safe handling of medications
■ Educational resources and advocacy for persons served in decision making
■ Physician review of medication use
■ Training and education for persons served regarding medications

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- The organization stores all medications for the individuals served together in a locked cabinet. Okanagan Inclusion might consider utilizing small boxes or other containers to separate medications for each individual.
- Discontinued or other unused medications are disposed of by returning them to the parent, guardian, or service provider with whom the individual resides, as appropriate. It is suggested that the organization provide some form of documentation to give proof of chain of custody.

2.D. Employment Services Principle Standards

Description

An organization seeking CARF accreditation in the area of employment services provides individualized services and supports to achieve identified employment outcomes. The array of services and supports may include:

■ Identification of employment opportunities and resources in the local job market.
■ Development of viable work skills that match workforce needs within the geographic area.
■ Development of realistic employment goals.
■ Establishment of service plans to achieve employment outcomes.
■ Identification of resources and supports to achieve and maintain employment.
■ Coordination of and referral to employment-related services and supports.

The organization maintains its strategic positioning in the employment sector of the community by designing and continually improving its services based on input from the persons served and from employers in the local job market, and managing results of the organization's outcomes management system. The provision of quality employment services requires a continuous focus on the persons served and the personnel needs of employers in the organization's local job market.

Some examples of the quality results desired by the different stakeholders of these services and supports include:

■ Individualized, appropriate accommodations.
■ A flexible, interactive process that involves the person.
■ Increased independence.
■ Increased employment options.
■ Timely services and reports.
■ Persons served obtain and maintain employment consistent with their preferences, strengths, and needs.
■ Person served obtains a job at minimum wage or higher and maintains appropriate benefits.
■ Person served maintains the job.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Goals of the persons served
■ Community resources available
■ Personnel needs of local employers
■ Economic trends in the local employment sector

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

2.E. Community Services Principle Standards

Description

An organization seeking CARF accreditation in the area of community services assists the persons and/or families served in obtaining access to the resources and services of their choice. The persons and/or families served are included in their communities to the degree they desire. This may be accomplished by direct service provision or linkages to existing opportunities and natural supports in the community.

The organization obtains information from the persons and/or families served regarding resources and services they want or require that will meet their identified needs, and offers an array of services it arranges for or provides. The organization provides the persons and/or families served with information so that they may make informed choices and decisions.

The services and supports are changed as necessary to meet the identified needs of the persons and/or families served and other stakeholders. Service designs address identified individual, family, socioeconomic, and cultural needs.

Expected results from these services may include:

- Increased or maintained inclusion in meaningful community activities.
- Increased or maintained ability to perform activities of daily living.
- Increased self-direction, self-determination, and self-reliance.
- Increased self-esteem.

Key Areas Addressed

- Access to community resources and services
- Enhanced quality of life
- Community inclusion
- Community participation

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Consultation

- Staff training regarding dementia is provided at the time of identification or diagnosis of the condition for the individuals served. The organization might consider offering training to all staff members to recognize early signs of aging or dementia.

Section 3. Employment Services

Description

An organization seeking CARF accreditation in the area of employment services assists the persons served through an individualized person-centred process to obtain access to the services, supports, and resources of their choice to achieve their desired outcomes. This may be accomplished by direct service provision, linkages to existing generic opportunities and natural supports in the community, or any combination of these. The persons served are included in their communities to the degree they desire.

The organization provides the persons served with information so that they may make informed choices and decisions. Although we use the phrase person served, this may also include family served, as appropriate to the service and the individual.

The services and supports are arranged and changed as necessary to meet the identified desires of the persons served. Service designs address identified individual, family, socioeconomic, and cultural preferences.

Depending on the program's scope of services, expected results from these services/supports may include:

- Increased inclusion in community activities.
- Increased self-direction, self-determination, and self-reliance.
- Self-esteem.
- Community citizenship.
- Increased independence.
- Meaningful activities.
- Increased employment options.
- Employment obtained and maintained.
- Competitive employment.
- Employment at or above minimum wage.
- Economic self-sufficiency.
- Employment with benefits.
- Career advancement.

3.G. Community Employment Services (CES)

Description

Community employment services assist persons to obtain successful community employment opportunities that are responsive to their choices and preferences. Through a strengths-based approach, the program provides person-directed services/supports to individuals to choose, achieve, and maintain employment in integrated community employment settings.

Work is a fundamental part of adult life. Individually tailored job development, training, and support recognize each person's employability and potential contribution to the labour market. Persons are supported as needed through an individualized person-centred model of services to choose and obtain a successful employment opportunity consistent with their preferences, keep the employment, and find new employment if necessary or for purposes of career advancement.

Such services may be described as individualized competitive employment, individual placements, contracted temporary personnel services, competitive employment, supported employment, transitional employment, mobile work crews, contracted work groups in the community, community-based SourceAmerica® contracts, and other business-based work groups in community-integrated designs. In Canada, employment in the form of bona fide volunteer placements is possible.

Individuals may be paid by community employers or by the organization. Employment is in the community.

The following service categories are available under Community Employment Services:

- Job Development (CES:JD)
- Employment Supports (CES:ES)

If an organization provides only Job Development or Employment Supports, then it may be accredited for only that service. If it is providing both Job Development and Employment Supports, then it must seek accreditation for both.

Note: In making the determination of what an organization is actually providing in comparison to these service descriptions, these factors are considered: the mission of the services, the program descriptions, brochures and marketing image for these services, and the outcomes of the services.

Depending on the scope of the services provided, some examples of the quality outcomes desired by the different stakeholders of these services include:

- Persons obtain community employment.
- Persons obtain individualized competitive employment.
- Employment matches interests and desires of persons.
- Wages, benefits, and hours of employment achieved as desired.
- Average number of hours worked per week increases.
- Average number of hours worked per week meets the desires of the person served.
- Full-time employment with benefits.
- Transition-age youth move directly from their educational environment into community employment.
- Potential for upward mobility.
- Self-sufficiency.
- Integration.
- Responsive services.
- Safe working conditions.
- Cost-effective for placement achieved.
- Performance level achieved meets requirements of job or position.
- Increase in skills.
- Increase in productivity.
- Increase in hours worked.
- Increase in pay.
- Employment retention.
- Increase in natural supports from coworkers.
- Persons served treated with respect.
- Minimize length of time for supports.
- Type and amount of staff interaction meets needs.
- Employer satisfaction.
- Responsiveness to customers.

Job Development (CES:JD): Successful job development concurrently uses assessment information about the strengths and interests of the person seeking employment to target the types of jobs available from potential employers in the local labour market. Typical job development activities include reviewing local employment opportunities and developing potential employers/customers through direct and indirect promotional strategies. Job development may include facilitating a hiring agreement between an employer and a person seeking employment. Some persons seeking employment may want assistance at only a basic, informational level, such as support for a self-directed job search.

Employment Supports (CES:ES): Employment support services promote successful training of a person to a new job, job adjustment, retention, and advancement. These services are based on the individual employee with a focus on achieving long-term retention of the person in the job. The level of employment support services is individualized to each employee and the complexity of the job.

Often supports are intensive for the initial orientation and training of an employee with the intent of leading to natural supports and/or reduced external job coaching. However, some persons may not require any employment supports at the job site; others may require intensive initial training with a quick decrease in supports, while some will be most successful when long-term supports are provided.

Supports can include assisting the employee with understanding the job culture, industry practices, and work behaviours expected by the employer. It may also include helping the employer and coworkers to understand the support strategies and accommodations needed by the worker.

Supports are a critical element of the long-term effectiveness of community employment. Support services address issues such as assistance in training a person to complete new tasks, changes in work schedule or work promotion, a decrease in productivity of the person served, adjusting to new supervisors, and managing changes in non-work environments or other critical life activities that may affect work performance. Routine follow-up with the employer and the employee is crucial to continued job success.

Key Areas Addressed

- Integrated employment choice
- Integrated employment obtainment
- Employment provided in regular business settings
- Integrated employment retention
- Provides career advancement resources

Recommendations

3.G.2.a.(1)
3.G.2.a.(2)
3.G.2.b.
3.G.2.c.
Okanagan Inclusion develops employment services for the individuals based on skills and preferences. A thorough person-centred assessment is completed with outreach to local employers. Individual service plans for job development should be individualized to the person seeking employment and involve the person's input and approval; be tracked in a systematic manner to ensure ongoing monitoring until employment is achieved; and be revised periodically, as necessary. This might be accomplished by developing the plan to reflect services provided during the preemployment period.

Section 4. Community Services

Description

An organization seeking CARF accreditation in the area of community services assists the persons served through an individualized person-centred process to obtain access to the services, supports, and resources of their choice to achieve their desired outcomes. This may be accomplished by direct service provision, linkages to existing generic opportunities and natural supports in the community, or any combination of these. The persons served are included in their communities to the degree they desire.

The organization provides the persons served with information so that they may make informed choices and decisions. Although we use the phrase person served, this may also include family served, as appropriate to the service and the individual.

The services and supports are arranged and changed as necessary to meet the identified desires of the persons served. Service designs address identified individual, family, socioeconomic, and cultural preferences.

Depending on the program's scope of services, expected results from these services/supports may include:

- Increased inclusion in community activities.
- Increased or maintained ability to perform activities of daily living.
- Increased self-direction, self-determination, and self-reliance.
- Self-esteem.
- Housing opportunities.
- Community citizenship.
- Increased independence.
- Meaningful activities.
- Increased employment options.

4.E. Host Family/Shared Living Services (HF/SLS)

Description

Host family/shared living services assist a person served to find a shared living situation in which the person is a valued person in the home and has supports as desired to be a participating member of the community. An organization may call these services, which are provided under a contract or written agreement with the host family/shared living provider, a variety of names, such as host family services, shared living services or supports, alternative family living, structured family care giving, family care, or home share.

Getting the person in the right match is a critical component to successful host family/shared living services. The organization begins by exploring with the person served what constitutes quality of life for the individual and identifies applicant host family/shared living providers who are a potential match with the person's identified criteria. The person served makes the final decision of selecting a host family/shared living provider.

Safety, responsibility, and respect between or amongst all people in the home are guiding principles in these services. Persons are supported to have meaningful reciprocal relationships both within the home, where they contribute to decision making, and in the community. The host family/shared living provider helps the person served to develop natural supports and strengthen existing networks. Relationships with the family of origin or extended family are maintained as desired by the person served. The host family/shared living provider supports the emotional, physical, and personal well-being of the person.

Persons develop their personal lifestyle and modify the level of support over time, if they so choose. The host family/shared living provider encourages and supports the person served to make decisions and choices.

The host family/shared living provider does not necessarily have to be a family, as it could be an individual supporting the person. Although the "home" is generally the host family/shared living provider's home or residence, it may also be the home of the person served.

Some examples of the quality results desired by the different stakeholders of these services and supports include:

- Quality of life, as identified by the person served, is enhanced.
- Increased independence.
- Increased community access.
- Persons served choose whom they will live with and where.
- Participation of the persons in the community.
- Community membership.
- Support for personal relationships.
- Increased natural supports.
- Strengthened personal networks.
- Supports accommodate individual needs.

■ Persons feel safe.
■ Persons feel that the supports they need/want are available.
■ Persons decide where they live.
■ Persons feel valued.
■ Persons have meaningful relationships.
■ Persons develop natural supports.
■ Persons participate in their community.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Appropriate matches of non-family participants with homes
■ Contracts that identify roles, responsibilities, needs, and monitoring
■ Needed supports
■ Community living services in a long-term family-based setting
■ Sense of permanency

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

4.G. Community Integration (COI)

Description

Community integration is designed to help persons to optimize their personal, social, and vocational competency to live successfully in the community. Persons served are active partners in determining the activities they desire to participate in. Therefore, the settings can be informal to reduce barriers between staff members and persons served. An activity centre, a day program, a clubhouse, and a drop-in centre are examples of community integration services. Consumer-run programs are also included.

Community integration provides opportunities for the community participation of the persons served. The organization defines the scope of these services and supports based on the identified needs and desires of the persons served. This may include services for persons who without this option are at risk of receiving services full-time in more restrictive environments with intensive levels of supports such as hospitalization or nursing home care. A person may participate in a variety of community life experiences or interactions that may include, but are not limited to:

■ Leisure or recreational activities.
■ Communication activities.
■ Spiritual activities.
■ Cultural activities.
■ Pre-vocational experiences.
■ Vocational pursuits.
■ Volunteerism in the community.
■ Educational and training activities.
■ Development of living skills.
■ Health and wellness promotion.
■ Orientation, mobility, and destination training.
■ Access and utilization of public transportation.
■ Interacting with volunteers from the community in program activities.
■ Community collaborations and social connections developed by the program (partnerships with community entities such as senior centres, arts councils, etc.).

Some examples of the quality results desired by the different stakeholders of these services include:

■ Community participation.
■ Increased independence.
■ Increased interdependence.
■ Greater quality of life.
■ Skill development.
■ Slowing of decline associated with aging.
■ Volunteer placement.
■ Movement to employment.
■ Centre-based socialization activities during the day that enable persons to remain in their community residence.
■ Activity alternatives to avoid or reduce time spent in more restrictive environments, such as hospitalization or nursing home care.

Key Areas Addressed

■ Opportunities for community participation

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

4.I. Supported Living (SL)

Description

Supported living addresses the desires, goals, strengths, abilities, needs, health, safety, and life span issues of persons usually living in their own homes (apartments, townhouses, or other residential settings). Supported living services are generally long-term in nature but may change in scope, duration, intensity, or location as the needs and preferences of individuals change over time.

Supported living refers to the support services provided to the person served, not the residence in which these services are provided. A sample of people receiving services/supports in these sites will be visited as part of the interview process. Although the residence will generally be owned, rented, or leased by the person who lives there, the organization may occasionally rent or lease an apartment when the person served is unable to do so. Typically, in this situation the organization would co-sign or in other ways guarantee the lease or rental agreement; however, the person served would be identified as the tenant.

Supported living programs may be referred to as supported living services, independent living, supportive living, semi-independent living, and apartment living, and services/supports may include home health aide and personal care attendant services. Typically there would not be more than two or three persons served living in a residence, no house rules or structure would be applied to the living situation by the organization, and persons served can come and go as they please. Service planning often identifies the number of hours and types of support services provided.

Some examples of the quality results desired by the different stakeholders of these services/supports include:

■ Persons served achieving choice of housing, either rent or ownership.
■ Persons served choosing whom they will live with, if anyone.
■ Minimizing individual risks.
■ Persons served have access to the benefits of community living.
■ Persons served have autonomy and independence in making life choices.

Key Areas Addressed

- Safe, affordable, accessible housing chosen by the individual
- Supports available based on needs and desires
- In-home safety needs
- Living as desired in the community
- Support personnel available based on needs
- Persons have opportunities to access community activities

Recommendations

There are no recommendations in this area.

Program(s)/Service(s) by Location

1175763 B.C. Ltd. dba Okanagan Inclusion

527 Ellis Street
Penticton BC V2A 4M4
CANADA

Community Employment Services: Employment Supports
Community Employment Services: Job Development
Community Integration
Host Family/Shared Living Services
Supported Living

Keremeos Community Options

427 7th Avenue
Keremeos BC V0X 1N3
CANADA

Community Integration